

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign - Ph.D. Candidate in Information Science, School of Information Science - Advisor: Jiaqi Ma	Illinois Aug. 2023–Present
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign - M.S. in Applied Mathematics, College of Liberal Arts & Sciences - Concentration: Optimization and Algorithms	Illinois Aug. 2023–Aug. 2025
University of Michigan - B.S. in Computer Science with Summa Cum Laude, College of Engineering - Minor: Mathematics, College of Literature, Science, and the Arts	Michigan Aug. 2021–May 2023
Shanghai Jiao Tong University - B.E. in Electrical and Computer Engineering, UM-SJTU Joint Institute - Minor: Computer Science, UM-SJTU Joint Institute	Shanghai, China Aug. 2019–Aug. 2023

RESEARCH AND INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Deep Learning Research, Susquehanna International Group Machine Learning Ph.D. Intern	Pennsylvania June 2026–Aug. 2026
ML Security Team, Anthropic AI Safety Research Fellows	San Francisco Jan. 2026–May 2026
AWS AI Lab, Amazon Applied Scientist Intern	New York May 2025–Aug. 2025
Sugiyama Laboratory, National Institute of Informatics Research Intern	Tokyo, Japan May 2024–Aug. 2024
SURE Program, University of Michigan Undergraduate Researcher	Michigan May 2022–Apr. 2023

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS

(* denotes equal contribution)

- [C1] **Pingbang Hu**, Mahito Sugiyama, “Pseudo-Nonlinear Data Augmentation: A Constrained Energy Minimization Viewpoint”. In *Proceedings of the 14th International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2026)* 
- [C2] **Pingbang Hu**, Joseph Melkonian, Weijing Tang, Han Zhao, Jiaqi W. Ma, “GRASS: Scalable Data Attribution with Gradient Sparsification and Sparse Projection”. In *Proceedings of the 39th Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2025)* 
- [C3] Yiwen Tu*, **Pingbang Hu***, Jiaqi W. Ma, “A Reliable Cryptographic Framework for Empirical Machine Unlearning Evaluation”. In *Proceedings of the 39th Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2025)* 
- [C4] Xinhe Wang, **Pingbang Hu**, Junwei Deng, Jiaqi W. Ma, “Adversarial Attacks on Data Attribution”. In *Proceedings of the 13th International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2025)* 
- [C5] Yuzheng Hu, **Pingbang Hu**, Han Zhao, Jiaqi W. Ma, “Most Influential Subset Selection: Challenges, Promises, and Beyond”. In *Proceedings of the 38th Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2024)* 
- [C6] Junwei Deng*, Ting-Wei Li*, Shiyuan Zhang, Yijun Pan, Hao Huang, Xinhe Wang, **Pingbang Hu**, Xingjian Zhang, Jiaqi W. Ma, “**datttri**: A Library for Efficient Data Attribution”. In *Proceedings of the 38th Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems Datasets and Benchmarks Track (NeurIPS 2024)* (**Spotlight**) 

WORKSHOP PAPERS

(* denotes equal contribution)

- [W1] **Pingbang Hu**, Yuzheng Hu, Jiaqi W. Ma, Han Zhao, “A Unified Theory of Random Projection for Influence Functions”. In *3rd Workshop on Navigating and Addressing Data Problems for Foundation Models (ICLR 2026)* 

- [P1] **Pingbang Hu**, Xueshen Liu, Z. Morley Mao, Jiaqi W. Ma, “**Dr. Post-Training: A Data Regularization Perspective on LLM Post-Training**”. *Preprint* 
- [P2] Junwei Deng, **Pingbang Hu**, Suliang Jin, Hao Lu, Jiachen T. Wang, Shichang Zhang, Jiaqi W. Ma, “How Faithful Is Trajectory-Based Data Attribution? Error Sources, Remedies, and Practical Guidelines”. *Preprint* 
- [P3] Junwei Deng*, Yuzheng Hu*, **Pingbang Hu***, Ting-Wei Li*, Shixuan Liu*, et al., “A Survey of Data Attribution: Methods, Applications, and Evaluation in the Era of Generative AI”. *Preprint* 

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign** **Illinois**
- Hold discussion and office hours weekly, design assignments and exam problems, grade and guide projects.
 - Network Analysis**: A graduate-level course on the M.S. IS track. *Spring 2025, Spring 2026*
- Instructional Aide, University of Michigan** **Michigan**
- Hold discussion and office hours weekly, design assignments and exam problems, grade and guide projects.
 - Introduction to Cryptography**: An upper-level course on the main undergraduate CS track. *Winter 2023*
 - Randomness and Computation**: A graduate-level course on the M.S. CS theory track. *Fall 2022*
- Teaching Assistant, Shanghai Jiao Tong University** **Shanghai, China**
- Hold discussion and office hours weekly, design and grade assignments and exams.
 - Honor Mathematics III**: An undergraduate-level course on the main B.Eng. ECE track. *Summer 2021*
 - * **Competition**: Hold the 1st UM-SJTU **JIntegration Bee competition**.
 - Honor Mathematics II**: An undergraduate-level course on the main B.Eng. ECE track. *Fall 2020*

INVITED TALKS

- Agentic Backdoor via Pre-Training Poisoning**
- Anthropic* *May 2026*
- Science of Data: Predictable, Optimizable, and Scalable**
- Citadel GQS PhD Colloquium* *May 2026*
- Towards Market Data Valuation under Complex Training**
- Susquehanna International Group* *Aug. 2026*

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Anthropic AI Safety Research Fellowship** **San Francisco**
- Fellows (32 out of 2000+ applicants worldwide) for AI Safety Research at Anthropic* *Oct. 2025*
- Graduate Conference Travel Award** **Illinois**
- Graduate College's Competition at University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign* *Nov. 2024*
- NeurIPS 2024 Scholar Award** **British Columbia, Canada**
- Financial Aid Award for NeurIPS 2024* *Oct. 2024*
- Excellent Internship Award** **Tokyo, Japan**
- Excellent (best) internship evaluation at National Institute of Informatics* *Aug. 2024*
- Hong Kong, Macao and Taiwan Overseas Chinese Student Scholarship** **Shanghai, China**
- First Prize (Ranked #2) among all HK, MC, and TW students at Shanghai Jiao Tong University* *Oct. 2021*
- Undergraduate Excellent Scholarship** **Shanghai, China**
- Third Prize among all students at UM-SJTU Joint Institute* *Nov. 2020*
- Bao Gang Excellent Scholarship** **Shanghai, China**
- Second Prize (Ranked #3) among all Taiwan students at Shanghai Jiao Tong University* *June 2020*
- Hong Kong, Macao and Taiwan Overseas Chinese Student Scholarship** **Shanghai, China**
- First Prize (Ranked #1) among all HK, MC, and TW students at UM-SJTU Joint Institute* *Dec. 2019*

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Workshop Organizer

- *The 3rd Workshop on Regulatable ML @NeurIPS 2025*

Program Committee

- *AAAI 2027, AAAI 2025*

Conference Reviewer

- *NeurIPS 2026, ICML 2026, ICLR 2026, NeurIPS 2025, ICLR 2025, ICML 2024, IEEE BigData 2023*

Journal Reviewer

- *TMLR*